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**Final Assignment**
Graded Assignment • 30 min

Due Sep 14, 11:59 PM IST

## Your grade: 100%

Your latest: 100% • Your highest: 100% • To pass you need at least 80%. We keep your highest score.

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1. **Congratulations on reaching the end of the course! Together, we have explored photographs from a variety of perspectives and approaches, bridging the gap between seeing and truly understanding photographs.**

1 / 1 point

**Take a moment to reflect on the course learning objectives:**

**• Develop a deeper understanding of artists' processes and the choices that inform a photograph's making, including modes of experimentation and responses to technological innovation.**

**• Learn how context influences the production, circulation, and reception of photographic images.**

**• Understand the relationship between a photograph's subject and its meaning, and consider the differences between photographs as objects and photographic images.**

**• Gain confidence in looking at and talking about photography, and find inspiration from photographs all around you.**

**Choose one of the learning objectives that resonates most with your experience in this course, and write a short reflection about it.**

**Please note that this assignment is graded on a pass/fail basis: any response that you write in will receive a passing grade for the assignment and course, but an empty box will receive a failing grade. We encourage you to use this opportunity for reflection, but how you choose to do so will be up to you!**

**After submitting your response, you are also welcome to repost it in this discussion forum for others' feedback. Please ensure you submit the assignment here first in order to receive credit for completing the course—posting it in the discussion forums without also submitting it here will not count towards completing the course.**

Reflection: Understanding the Relationship Between a Photograph's Subject and Its Meaning
Of all the learning objectives in this course, the one that resonated most with me was understanding the relationship between a photograph's subject and its meaning, and considering the differences between photographs as objects and photographic images.

Before this course, I tended to look at photographs as straightforward records of reality—what you see is what happened. But through the works we studied, I came to appreciate how much meaning is shaped by context, framing, sequencing, and intent.

Key moments that shifted my thinking:

Carrie Mae Weems' From Here I Saw What Happened and I Cried showed me how adding text and reframing historical images can completely transform their meaning—turning documentation into critique.

Martha Rosler's House Beautiful: Bringing the War Home demonstrated how juxtaposition forces viewers to confront what is usually kept separate—domestic comfort and distant violence.

Thomas Ruff's Jpeg series made me realize that the same subject can carry entirely different meaning depending on how the image is produced, degraded, or enlarged.

Deana Lawson's portraits blurred the line between staged fiction and documentary truth, showing that a photograph's meaning is never fixed.

What I take away:

A photograph is never just an image—it is an object with a history, a context, and a point of view. The same subject can mean radically different things depending on who made it, why, and how it is presented. This course gave me the vocabulary and confidence to look more carefully, ask better questions, and see photographs not just as windows onto the world, but as arguments about it.

Most importantly, I now find myself noticing photographs everywhere—in advertisements, news, social media, family albums—and asking: Who made this? What choices did they make? What is being shown, and what is being left out?

That shift in awareness is the most valuable thing I'm taking from this course.

Feedback

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